

Enable Two-Factor Authentication

Introduction

Two-factor authentication is an identity confirmation method that necessitates users to provide two forms of authentication, like a password and a one-time passcode (OTP), to verify their identity and access an online account or other vulnerable resources.

You can use one of your personal devices or accounts to enable two-factor authentication. This activity can be accomplished using a Windows machine, a Google account, or a Mac.

Learning objectives

After completing this activity, you will be able to:

- Enable two-factor authentication for a Microsoft account
- Activate two-factor authentication for a Google account
- Set up two-factor authentication on a Mac

Instructions

Complete one or more of the following exercises based on your devices and accounts.

Enable two-factor authentication for a Microsoft account

1. Visit <https://account.microsoft.com/>
2. Log in with your username and password.
3. From the top menu, select the **Security** tab.
4. In the **Security** tab, select **Advanced Security Options**.
5. Click **Add a new way to sign in or verify**.
6. You will see various methods to verify your identity. Select one of these options and follow the prompts to enable two-factor authentication for your Microsoft devices.

Activate two-factor authentication for a Google account

1. Visit myaccount.google.com
2. From the navigation panel on the left, select **Security**.
3. Under **How do you sign into Google**, select **2-Step Verification**.
4. Select **Get started**.
5. Follow the prompts to enable two-factor authentication for your Google accounts.

Set up two-factor authentication on a Mac

1. On your Mac, select the Apple menu.
2. Select **System Settings**.
3. From the top of the sidebar, select your name. If your name is not visible, select **Sign in with your Apple ID**. Then, enter your Apple ID and password.
4. Click **Sign-In & Security**.
5. Next to **Two-Factor Authentication**, select **Turn on**.
6. If prompted, enter your Apple ID and password again.
7. Provide answers to your security questions, and then click **Continue**.
8. Follow the prompts to enable two-factor authentication on your Apple devices.



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